Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI61 61% Fe Fines RMB/t

798
-3 -0.37%
Jan 21st, 2026

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

894
-4.00 -0.45%
Jan 21st, 2026

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

710
-1 -0.14%
Jan 21st, 2026

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI61 61% Fe Fines USD/dmt

104.85
-1.23 -1.16%
Jan 21st, 2026

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

120.58
-0.51 -0.42%
Jan 21st, 2026

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

883
3 0.34%
Week Ending Jan 16th, 2026

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2605 (May) RMB/t (3pm close)

784.00
-5.50 -0.70%
Jan 21st, 2026 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
December 25 USD/dmt

103.10
-0.80 -0.77%
Jan 21st, 2026 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2605 (Jan) RMB/t

3117
6 0.19%
Jan 21st, 2026 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

20.32
0.70 3.6%
Jan 20th, 2026

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

8.22
0.75 10.0%
Jan 20th, 2026

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3195
6 0.19%
Week Ending Jan 16th, 2026

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

148.76
1.73 1.18%
Week Ending Jan 16th, 2026

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

8.71
-0.01 -0.06%
Week Ending Jan 16th, 2026

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

3290
16 0.49%
Week Ending Jan 16th, 2026

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Jan 21st, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	798	-3	-0.4%	788	831	683	1063	105.79	-0.42	-0.4%	102.39	108.33	89.33	140.24
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	710	-1	-0.1%	692	729	610	963	94.73	-0.15	-0.2%	90.45	95.58	80.25	128.13
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	894	-4	-0.4%	899	942	794	1175	118.98	-0.56	-0.5%	117.30	123.31	104.47	155.37

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Jan 21st, 2026		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	104.85	-1.23	-1.16%	103.63	109.50	89.79	142.65
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	120.58	-0.51	-0.42%	115.14	123.89	98.23	171.65

MARKET COMMENTARY

Today, the iron ore futures market experienced volatile and slightly weaker movements. The main contract I2605 closed at 784 yuan/ton, down 0.32% from the previous trading day. Spot prices also saw a slight decline of about 1–2 yuan/ton compared to the previous day. Traders remained relatively active in offering prices, largely aligning with market trends. Steel mills, however, approached procurement cautiously, replenishing inventories based on immediate needs and exercising prudence in inquiries. Overall, market trading activity showed signs of improvement.

On the fundamental data front, the latest SMM survey indicates that the blast furnace capacity utilization rate among 242 sampled steel mills stood at 86.97%, with daily molten iron production reaching 2.3562 million tons—a slight decrease of 2,100 tons compared to the previous period. Overall, rigid demand for iron ore remained largely stable.

This week, pre-holiday inventory restocking by steel mills is expected to be concentrated, providing support to iron ore demand. However, given the persistently high port inventories and the ongoing ample supply situation, the fundamental landscape for iron ore continues to reflect a pattern of upper resistance and lower support. In the near term, iron ore prices are anticipated to maintain a volatile and slightly weak trend.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Jan 16th, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-oW	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	883	3	0.3%	898	958	820	1210	112.44	0.60	0.53%	112.34	120.26	102.77	153.57

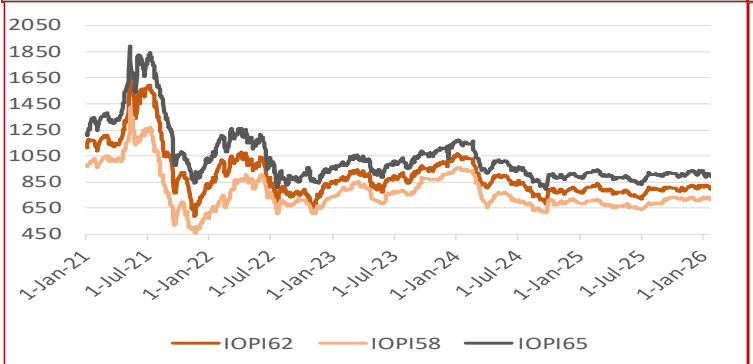
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Jan 16th, 2026				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	972	0.0%	859	1226	138.65	0.11%	119.88	172.59
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	990	0.5%	880	1300	141.22	0.62%	122.81	183.23
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	760	1.1%	690	970	108.41	1.18%	96.49	136.72
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1020	1.4%	878	1294	145.50	1.51%	122.53	182.16

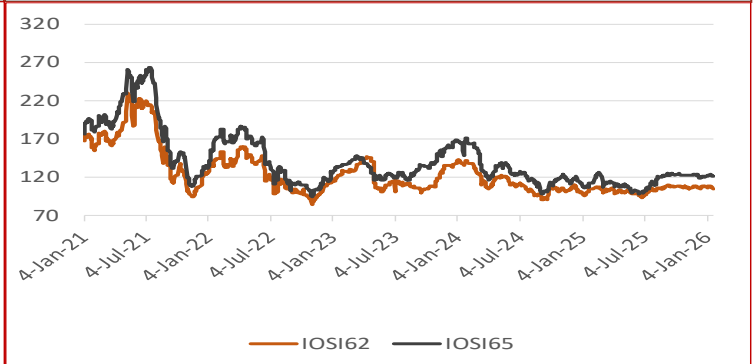
Week Ending Jan 16th, 2026	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	890.59	0.39%	802.20	905.40

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 7.191 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =7.19258

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Jan 21st, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	September	October	November	December	MTD	QTD	YTD	September	October	November	December	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	801	792	805	798	788	783	831	104.69	103.56	105.46	100.24	102.39	101.73	108.33
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	716	726	720	716	692	687	729	94.18	95.66	95.02	94.72	90.45	89.77	95.58
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	914	903	917	925	899	894	942	119.85	118.69	120.64	122.17	117.30	116.67	123.31

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Jan 21st, 2026		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	September	October	November	December	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	107.88	107.27	106.33	105.42	103.63	102.88	109.50
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	122.98	122.90	122.46	121.09	115.14	114.31	123.89

FREIGHT RATES

Jan 20th, 2026		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	8.22	0.75	10.0%	5.92	14.89
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	20.32	0.70	3.6%	16.08	35.02

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Jan 16th, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	September	October	November	December	MTD	QTD	YTD	September	October	November	December	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	926	909	880	864	898	894	958	116.51	114.52	110.83	109.14	112.34	111.86	120.26

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Jan 21st, 2026		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-88	-11.03%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	96	12.03%

Jan 21st, 2026		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	15.74	15.01%

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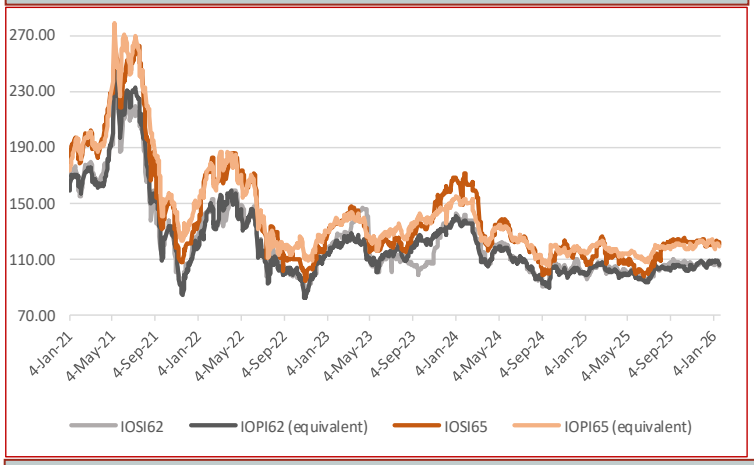
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Jan 21st, 2026	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	741	8	-57
SIMEC Fines	729	5	-69
PB Fines	790	0	-8
Newman Fines	807	14	9
MAC Fines	804	16	6
Jimblebar Blended Fines	734	11	-64
Carajas Fines	876	4	78
Brazilian SSF	765	19	-33
Brazilian Blend Fines	788	13	-10
RTX Fines	745	10	-53
West Pilbara Fines	783	14	-15

Jan 21st, 2026	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	97.20	-1.00	-7.65
SIMEC Fines	95.00	-1.20	-9.85
PB Fines	104.70	-1.20	-0.15
Newman Fines	98.55	-1.05	-6.30
MAC Fines	98.60	-0.90	-6.25
Jimblebar Blended Fines	93.15	-1.15	-11.70
Carajas Fines	120.50	-1.10	15.65
Brazilian SSF	100.30	-0.90	-4.55
Brazilian Blend Fines	110.30	-1.50	5.45
RTX Fines	94.20	-0.85	-10.65
West Pilbara Fines	96.10	-0.90	-8.75

Jan 21st, 2026	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	670	9	-40
FMG Blended Fines	727	13	17
Robe River	712	13	2
Western Fines	711	10	1
Atlas Fines	717	14	7
Yandi	704	10	-6

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	9.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	45.00	5.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	45.00	5.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	45.00	5.00
	Low Grade Fe	13.00	3.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	5.00	-3.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	66.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	20.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	11.00	6.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	40.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade	5.00	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	1.50	0.25
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	2.75	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	2.75	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	2.75	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	6.50	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	6.50	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	2.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	4.75	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	2.00	0.25
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	2.25	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-20.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-15.00	0.00	Lianyungang	-3.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-10.00	0.00	Jingtang	-12.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-20.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-15.00	0.00

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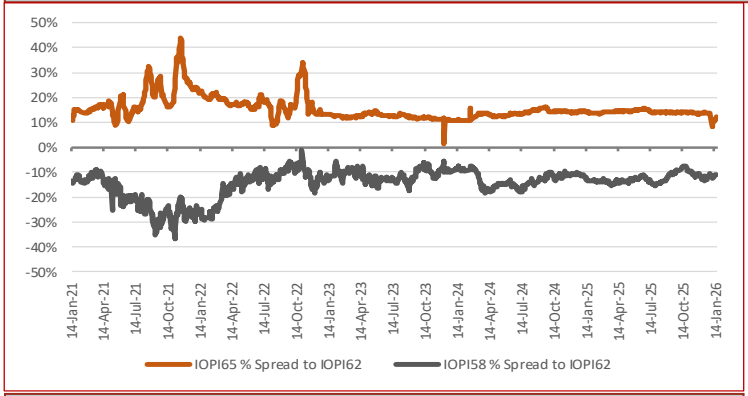
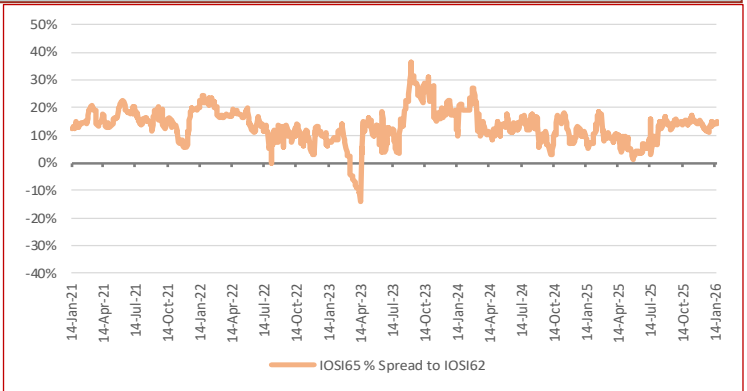
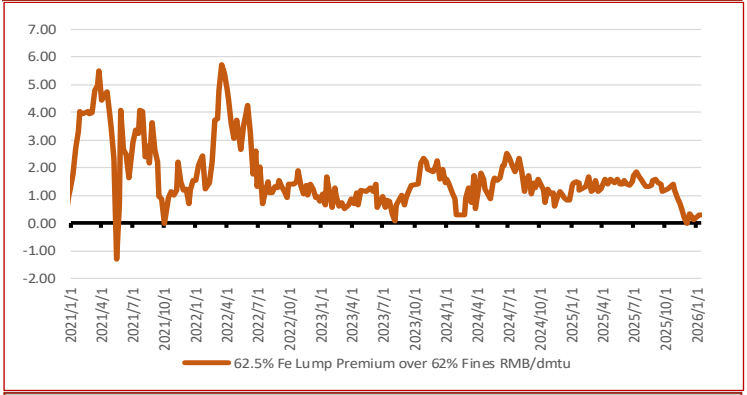
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

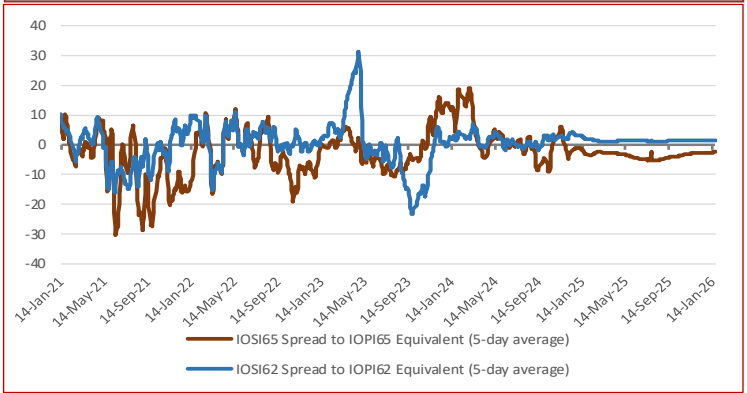




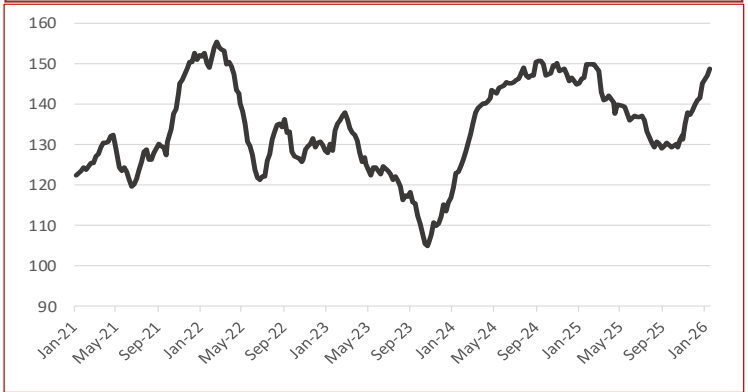
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



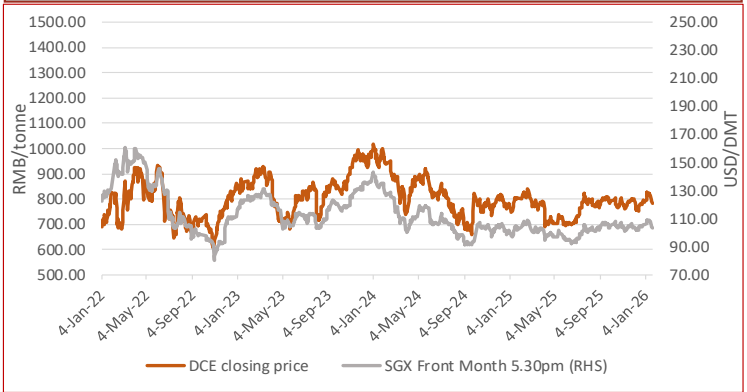
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

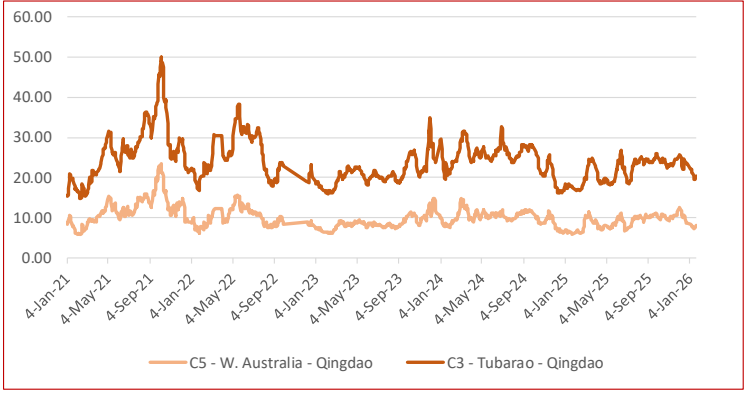
Week Ending Jan 16th, 2026

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	14.86	1.02%	8.29	17.20
Qingdao	32.27	1.06%	22.28	33.46
Caofeidian	15.99	5.61%	7.56	20.28
Tianjin	11.36	2.25%	6.64	12.36
Rizhao	14.73	0.75%	11.52	21.35
Total (35 Ports)	148.76	1.18%	105.01	150.72

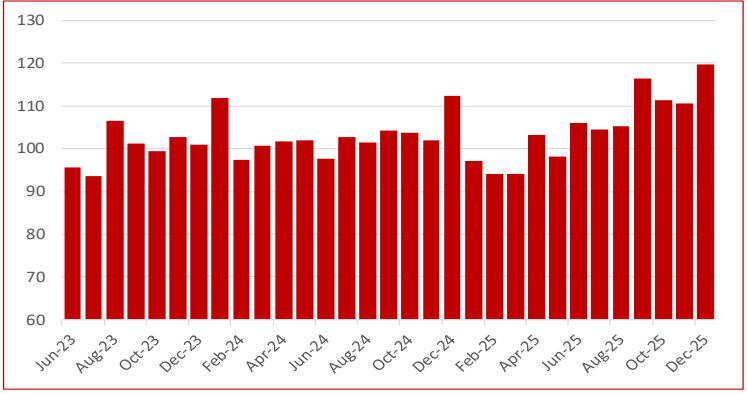
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Jan 21st, 3pm close			Jan 21st, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2605	Change	Change %	Jun. 26	Change	Change %
Closing Price	784.00	-5.50	-0.70%	103.10	-0.80	-0.77%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	22.51	-13.76	-37.94%	8.87	-3.45	-27.99%
Open positions ('000 lots)	57.52	-1.12	-1.90%	49.49	-3.09	-5.87%
Day Low	782.5	4.50	0.58%	103.00	-0.10	-0.10%
Day High	791.5	-6.50	-0.81%	10.35	-94.70	-90.15%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2026/01/16	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,195	6	0.19%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	3,386	4	0.12%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	3,290	16	0.49%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	3,823	-7	-0.18%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	3,363	0	0.00%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	4,097	-3	-0.08%
Colour Coated Plate	6,350	0	0.00%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

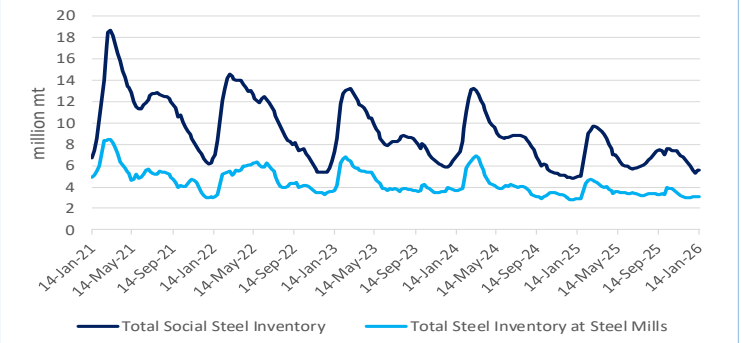
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	108.25	-0.19	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	1,605	0	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,380	50	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	2,579	4	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	3,140	4	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	60	-4	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,221	4	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	89	16	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

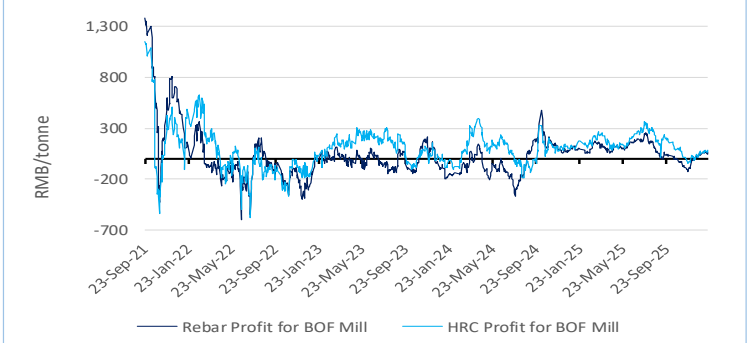
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

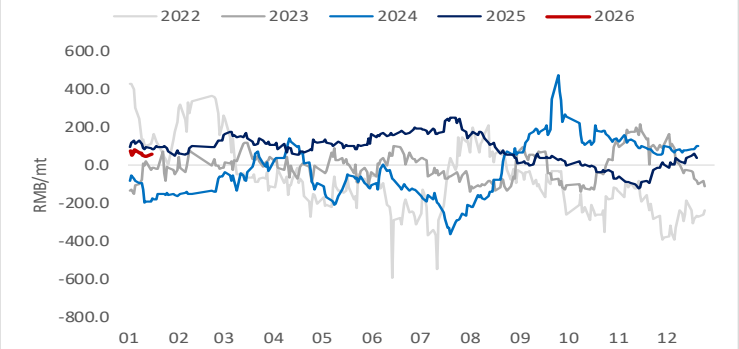
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



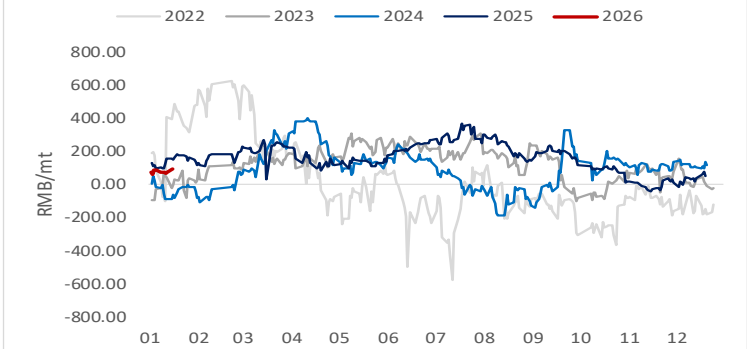
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



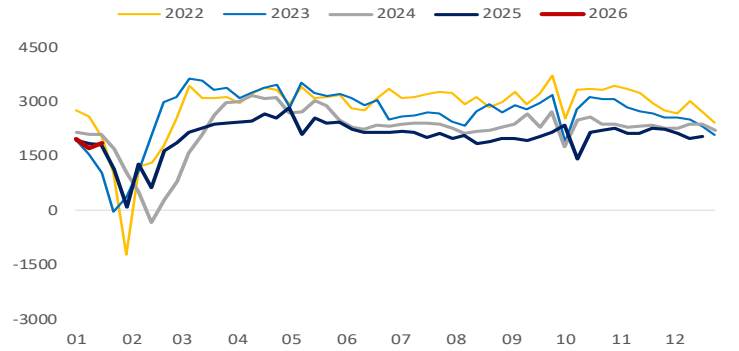
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



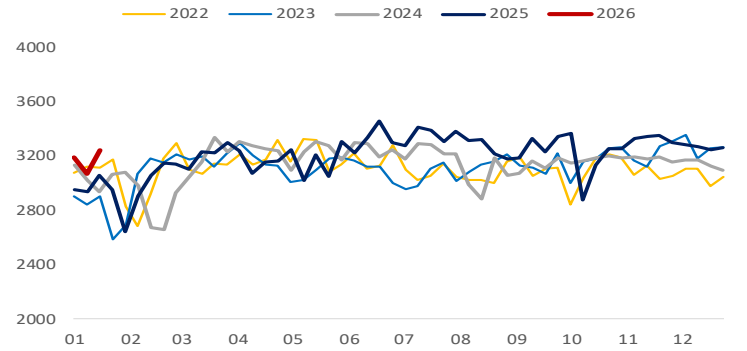
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



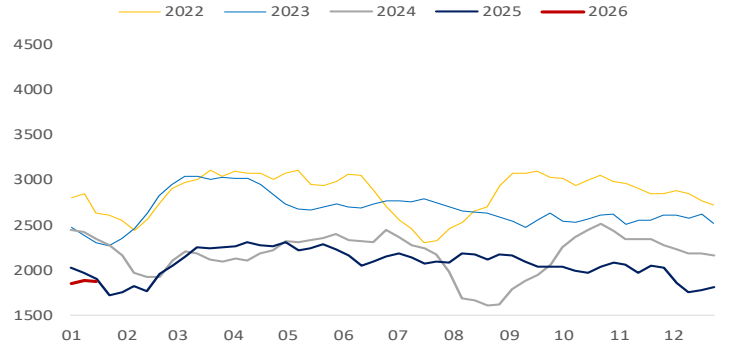
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



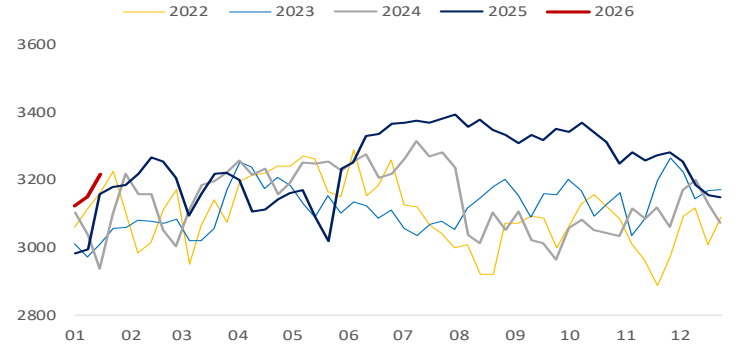
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Jan 21st, 2026	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Jan 21st, 2026	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.40%	0.090%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.70%	0.080%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.00%	4.50%	0.120%	8.00%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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